

could upload a video in any format, and YouTube transposed it to Flash and hosted it. Soon afterward, Roelof Botha, the ex CFO of PayPal and then of Sequio Capital, invested \$500,000 in YouTube. Soon it cracked the top 35,000 websites on Alexa. The next big step in its evolution came when Julie Supan joined as Head of Marketing in September 2005. On November 7, they



HotorNot also inspired Mark Zuckerberg to create the first version of Facebook. Is it possible that this website could be the most inspirational development of the internet age?

issued a press release stating that YouTube was “a consumer media company for people to watch and share original videos through a Web experience.”

YouTube was great at one thing - easily sharing content. All that was missing was viral content. That would change in November, as a Nike advertisement featuring Ronaldinho was uploaded on the site. In mid-December, an SNL video starring Andy Samberg and Chris Parnell also made it onto the website. By December 27, this video had logged over 1.2 million views – a huge milestone back then. After this inflection point, the only direction YouTube went was UP, with a capital U and a capital P. By January, they were getting 15 million hits per day, by March, 40 million, and by June, 80 million. The New York Times covered YouTube in April, where it was written that the website had the potential to make its own stars.

The interest in the company was so high that Supan and Hurley had dinner with Bill Gates in May 2006. By September 2006, Yahoo, Google, and News Corp. had all made contact with the eventual intention of buying. The rest of course, is history. Google bought YouTube, and in 2014, it accounted for one-tenth of its total value.